SEWING PATTERN · INSTRUCTION BOOKLET

Peter Pan Collar

GIRLS DRESS

A sweet A-line dress with a rounded Peter Pan collar, short set-in sleeves and twelve buttons down the back.



SIZES	LEVEL	SEAM ALLOWANCE	FORMATS
US 2 – 18 (12 sizes)	Confident beginner	1 cm (3/8 in) included	A4 · US Letter · A0

HELPFUL VIDEO GUIDES INCLUDED · CLICKABLE LINKS AND QR CODES ON PAGE 8

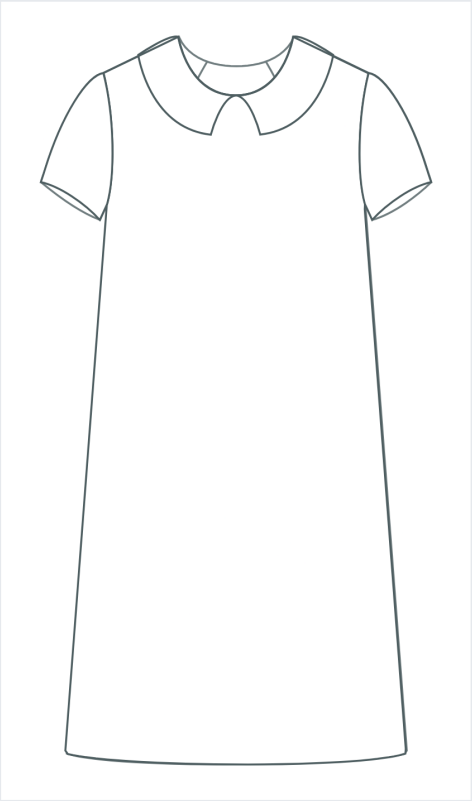
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WELCOME

Meet the Peter Pan Collar Dress

Thank you for choosing this pattern! This easy A-line dress is a classic for girls: a soft rounded collar, short sleeves and a row of little buttons down the back. It works for every day in cotton and looks just as lovely for parties in a fine linen or a soft corduroy. The steps below take you from cutting to the last button, with a picture for every step.

Design features



Front

- A-line (trapeze) shape, no waist seam, knee length on most sizes
- Rounded Peter Pan collar in two halves, finished with a neck facing
- Short set-in sleeves with a little ease at the cap
- Full-length back opening with 12 buttons (1 cm)
- One-piece front, no darts; small back shoulder darts on sizes 7–18
- Clean inside: neck and back opening finished with a one-piece facing

What is included

- This illustrated instruction booklet
- Printable pattern files in A4, US Letter and A0, one file per size
- Sizes US 2 to 18 (12 sizes, ages about 2 to 16)
- Helpful video guides with clickable links and QR codes on page 8

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Seven quick checks

A few minutes here save a lot of unpicking later.

- [ ] Print the test square first (10 cm / 4 in at 100 % or "Actual size") and measure it before printing all pages.
- [ ] Choose the size from the child's chest measurement (page 4). The dress has about 5 cm of ease at the chest, so it is not tight. Between two sizes, take the larger one.
- [ ] Check the length. Each size is drafted for the height in the chart. To lengthen or shorten, add or remove length at the hem of the Front, Back and Back Neck Facing by the same amount, keeping the A-line shape.
- [ ] Transfer every marking: notches, center front, center back, dart lines, ease circles on the sleeve, buttons and buttonholes.
- [ ] Allowances: 1 cm (3/8 in) seam allowance on every edge, 2 cm (3/4 in) hem on the dress and on the sleeves.
- [ ] Test on a scrap: your stitch length (2.5 mm), the fusible interfacing and one buttonhole.
- [ ] The trickiest part is the collar and facing at the neckline (steps 4 to 6). Take your time, pin well and press at every stage.

Pressing tip

Pre-wash the fabric the way the dress will be washed. Press every seam as soon as it is sewn, and press the collar and the facing edges from the wrong side, rolling the seam slightly to the inside so it does not show.

SIZE CHARTS

Find the right size

Measure the child over light clothing. Choose the size from the chest; the dress is loose at the waist and hips.

Body measurements (cm)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Height	91.4	99.1	106.7	114.3	120.7	127	132	144.8	157.8	162	163.8	165
Chest	53.3	54.6	56.5	58.4	60.3	58.5	63.8	70	75	78.8	82.8	85.2
Waist	48.9	50.5	52.1	54	55.9	52.8	56	59.2	62.2	64	66.2	68
Hips	52.7	54.6	57.5	60.3	63.2	62.8	67.5	75	80.2	85	90.2	92.8

Body measurements (inches)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Height	36	39	42	45	47 1/2	50	52	57	62 1/8	63 3/4	64 1/2	65
Chest	21	21 1/2	22 1/4	23	23 3/4	23	25 1/8	27 1/2	29 1/2	31	32 5/8	33 5/8
Waist	19 1/4	19 7/8	20 1/2	21 1/4	22	20 3/4	22	23 3/8	24 1/2	25 1/4	26 1/8	26 3/4
Hips	20 3/4	21 1/2	22 5/8	23 3/4	24 7/8	24 3/4	26 5/8	29 1/2	31 5/8	33 1/2	35 1/2	36 1/2

Finished dress measurements (cm)

US size	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	10	12	14	16	18
Chest	58.3	59.6	61.5	63.4	65.3	63.5	68.8	75	80	83.8	87.8	90.2
Waist	61.5	63.3	65.8	68.4	70.8	67.3	72.6	79.9	85.6	90.4	95.3	98
Hips	65.8	68.3	71.8	75.2	78.6	72.8	78.2	86.9	93	98.5	104.5	107.3
Hem sweep	73.4	77.3	82.9	88.1	93.8	84	90.1	101.5	108.7	115.3	123.3	126.5
Back length*	51.6	56.4	61.2	66	70	73	76.2	84.2	92.4	95.1	96.2	97
Sleeve length	14.2	14.7	15.2	15.9	16	16.3	16.5	17.6	18.9	19.8	19.6	19.5

* Back length = center back, from the neckline seam to the finished hem. Size 7 is drafted from a slimmer body chart than size 6 (chest 58.5 cm): if the child measures between, compare the finished chest above. Kids' sizes vary between brands: always measure.

FABRIC & NOTIONS

What you need

Choose a light to medium-weight woven fabric that holds a crisp collar and presses well.

- Best: cotton poplin, cotton lawn, chambray, gingham, light linen or linen-cotton blend.
- Also nice: baby needlecord (fine corduroy), viyella or brushed cotton for winter.
- Collar: the same fabric, or a white cotton or a contrast print for a classic look.
- Avoid: stretch knits and very slippery fabrics for a first make.

Fabric requirements

Sizes	150 cm (60 in) wide	115 cm (45 in) wide	Fusible interfacing 90 cm
2 – 6	0.9 m · 1 yd	1.6 m · 1 3/4 yd	0.5 m · 5/8 yd
7 – 10	1.3 m · 1 1/2 yd	2.0 m · 2 1/4 yd	0.5 m · 5/8 yd
12 – 18	1.5 m · 1 3/4 yd	2.4 m · 2 5/8 yd	0.5 m · 5/8 yd

Quantities are estimates: every piece of each size was laid out without folding, with a small safety margin. Add extra for matching checks or one-way prints.

Notions

- 12 buttons, 1 cm (3/8 in) diameter (all sizes)
- Matching all-purpose thread
- Light fusible interfacing for the facings and the collar
- Hand sewing needle, pins or clips, a point turner

Printing & assembling

- A4 / US Letter: print at 100 % ("Actual size"). Each page is labelled like "1/1, 1/2…": the pages with the same second number form one row. Trim the right edge of each page, overlap on the next page, match the crosses and tape.
- A0: send the file to a copy shop and ask for printing at 100 % scale.

PATTERN PIECES

Pieces & cutting

Six pattern pieces. Cut the fabric right sides together for the pairs.

#	Piece	Cut from	Cut
1	Front	Main fabric	1 (drawn whole: cut single layer)
2	Back	Main fabric	2 (one left, one right: mirror)
3	Sleeve	Main fabric	2 (mirror)
4	Front Neck Facing	Main fabric + interfacing	1 (drawn whole: cut single layer)
5	Back Neck Facing	Main fabric + interfacing	2 (mirror)
6	Peter Pan Collar	Main fabric + interfacing	4 (2 left + 2 right: 2 pairs, mirror)

Cutting tips

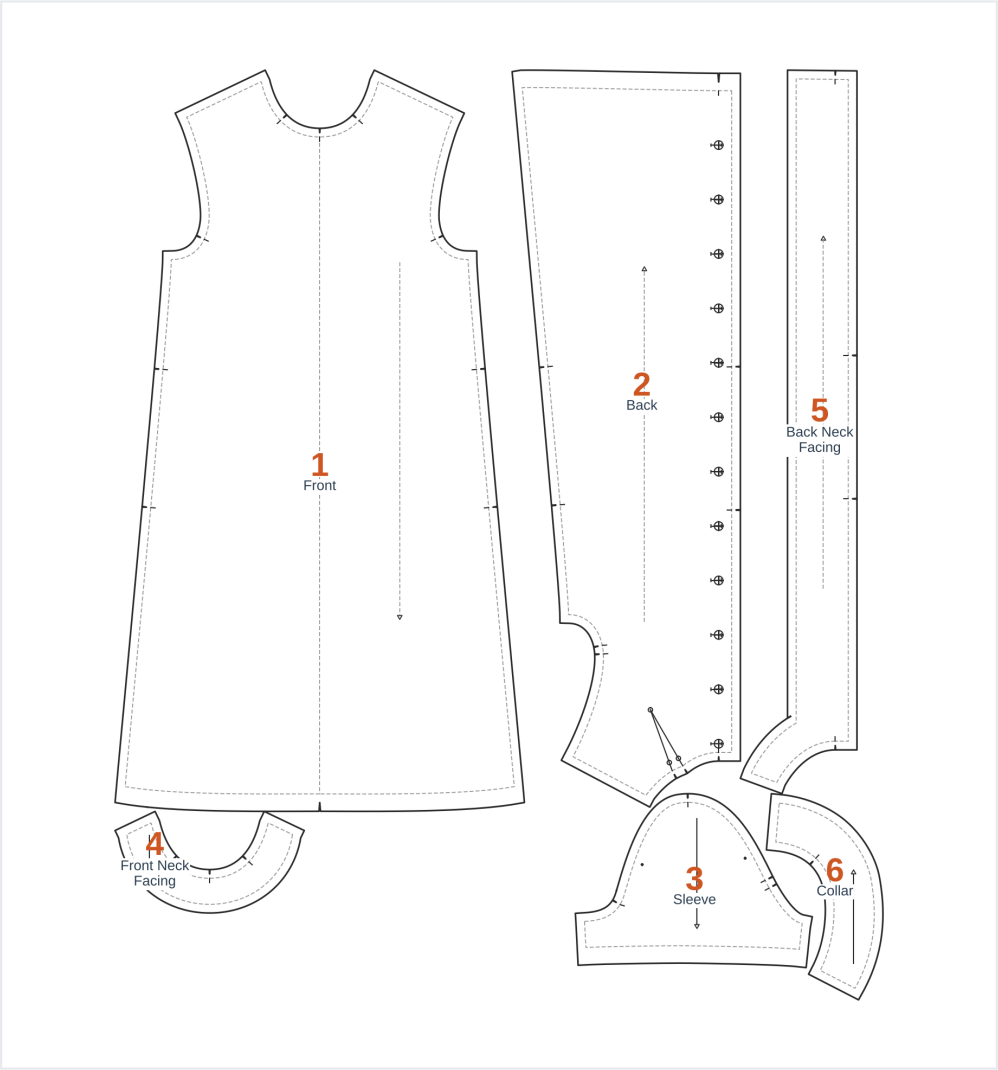
- The Front and the Front Neck Facing are drawn whole, with the center front line in the middle: cut them from a single layer of fabric, right side up, not on the fold.
- Follow the grainline arrow on every piece, parallel to the selvedge.
- Fuse interfacing to the wrong side of the Front Neck Facing, both Back Neck Facings and 2 collar pieces (one left, one right: these become the upper collar). For a firmer collar, interface all 4.
- Snip the notches (max. 5 mm) and mark buttons, buttonholes, darts and ease circles with chalk or a fabric pen.

Sewing order at a glance

1 Staystitch, finish the edges, interfacing	2 Back shoulder darts (7–18)
3 Shoulders	4 Make and baste the collar
5 Prepare the facing	6 Facing: neck + back opening
7 Side seams	8 Sleeves
9 Hems	10 Buttonholes and buttons

PIECES & MARKINGS

Know your pieces



All pieces, size 8 shown

Mark	Meaning
Solid outer line	Cutting line (1 cm seam allowance and 2 cm hems included)
Grey dashed line	Stitching line
Notches (short lines on the edge)	Match these between pieces: side seams, armholes, sleeve cap, collar, facing
Notch at the top of the sleeve	Matches the shoulder seam
Line through the middle of the Front	Center front (also marks where the two collar halves meet)
Notch near the back opening edge	Center back: the collar ends here, and the buttons sit on this line
Circle with a cross + short line	Button (on the left back) and horizontal buttonhole 1.2 cm (on the right back)
Two lines + small circles at the back neck	Back shoulder dart (sizes 7–18): stitch from the shoulder edge to the circle at the tip
Two dots on the sleeve cap (EASE)	Easestitch the sleeve cap between these points
Arrow	Grainline: parallel to the selvedge

HELPFUL VIDEO GUIDES

Watch & learn

Scan a QR code with your phone or click "Watch the video". Each video shows one technique used in this dress.

Sewing darts Watch the video Used in Step 2	Attaching a rounded (flat) collar Watch the video Used in Steps 4–6	Understitching a facing Watch the video Used in Step 6
Easing and setting in a sleeve Watch the video Used in Step 8	Hemming a curved edge Watch the video Used in Step 9	Perfect buttonholes Watch the video Used in Step 10

These videos are made by independent creators. The technique is the same, but always follow the measurements and the order of this guide.

SEWING INSTRUCTIONS

Let's sew

Seam allowance is 1 cm (3/8 in) unless noted. "RS" = right side, "WS" = wrong side.

1 Prepare the pieces

All pieces

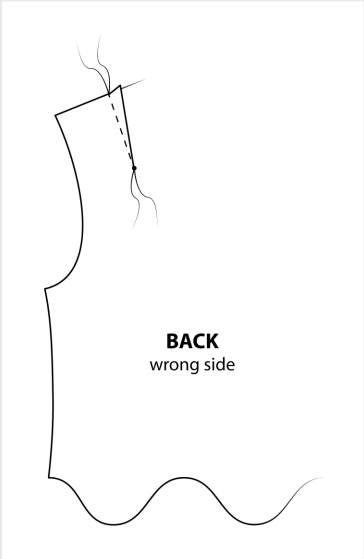
- Fuse the interfacing to the Front Neck Facing, the two Back Neck Facings and the two upper collar pieces (see page 6).
- Staystitch the neckline of the Front and of both Backs, 7 mm from the edge, so the curves do not stretch.
- Finish (zigzag or overlock) the side seams of the Front and Backs and the underarm edges of the Sleeves, one piece at a time.
- Lay the pieces out in order, with all markings visible on the wrong side.

2 Back shoulder darts

Back · sizes 7–18

- Sizes 2–6 have no dart: skip to step 3.
- Fold each dart right sides together, matching the two lines. Pin.
- Stitch from the shoulder edge towards the circle at the tip. Do not backstitch at the tip: leave long thread tails and knot them.
- Press the darts toward the center back.

Video help: Sewing darts

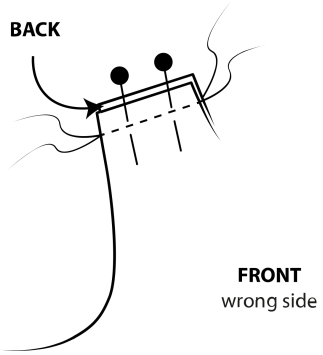


Back, wrong side

3 Sew the shoulders

Front + Backs

- Place the Front on the Backs, right sides together, and pin at the shoulders.
- Stitch, finish the seam allowances separately and press them open.

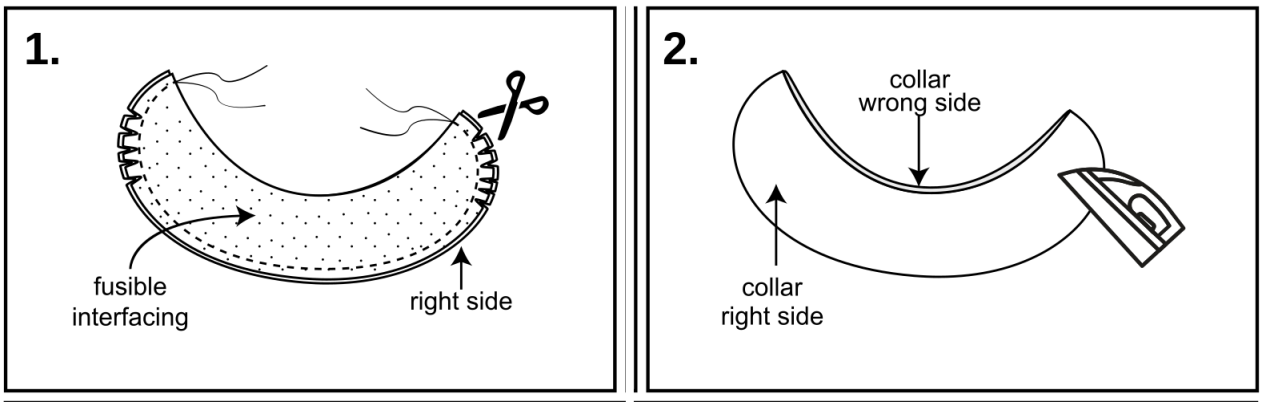


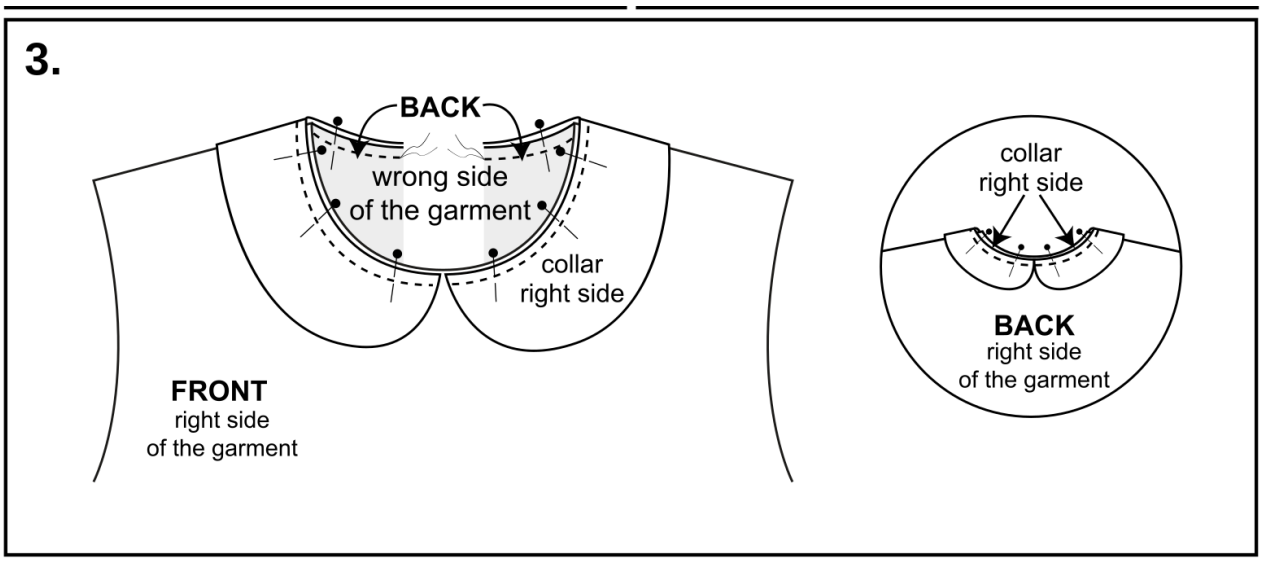
4 Make the collar

Collar · pictures 1–3

- Pair each interfaced collar piece with a plain one, right sides together (you get a left and a right collar).
- Stitch around the outer curved edge and the two short ends; leave the neck edge open. Notch the outer curve 2 mm from the stitching and trim to 5 mm (picture 1).
- Turn right side out, push the curve out gently and press, rolling the seam slightly to the under side (picture 2).
- Pin both collars on the right side of the neckline, under-collar down, matching the notches. The front ends meet at the center front; the back ends stop at the center back notch of each Back, 1.5 cm in from the opening edge (picture 3). Baste 7 mm from the edge.

Video help: Attaching a rounded collar

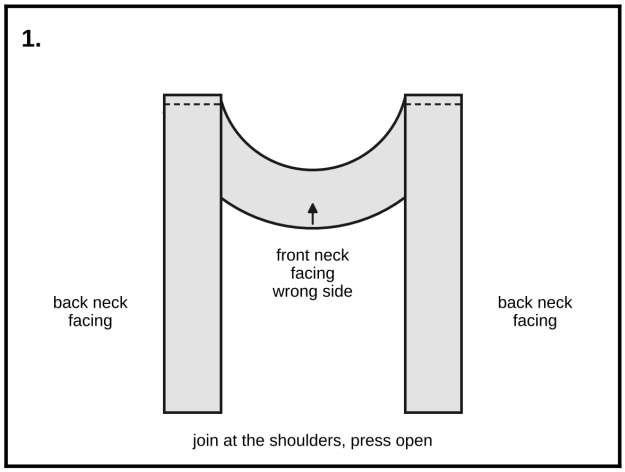


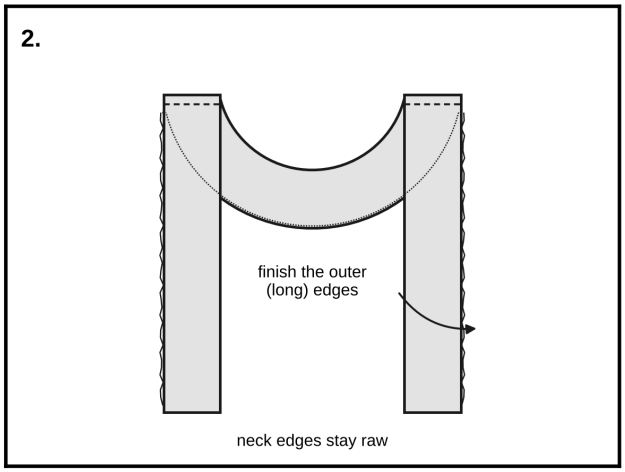


5 Prepare the facing

Facings 4 + 5 · pictures 1–2

- Pin the Front Neck Facing to the two Back Neck Facings at the shoulders, right sides together. Stitch and press the seams open (picture 1).
- Finish the long outer edge of the facing (zigzag or overlock), all around. The neck edge and the back opening edges stay raw (picture 2).
- If needed, press the lower 1 cm of each Back Neck Facing to the wrong side.



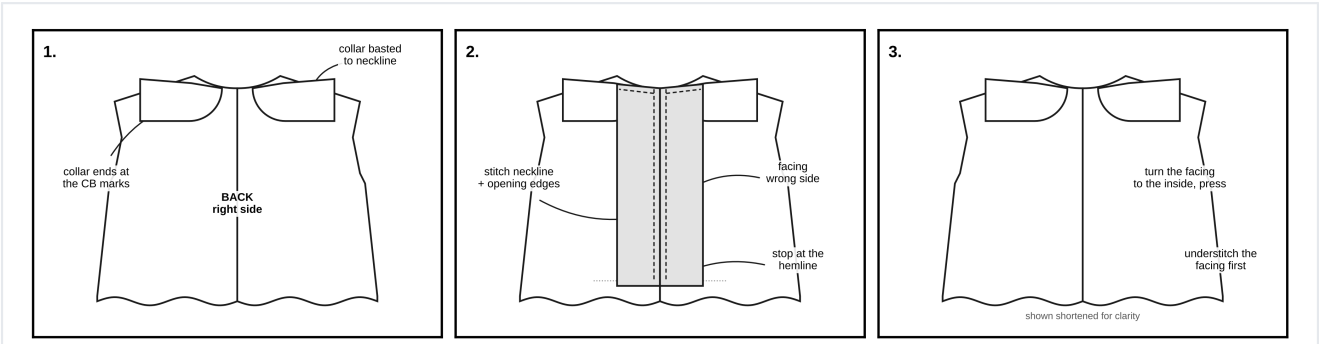


6 Facing: neckline and back opening

Facing over collar · pictures 1–3

- Lay the dress flat, right side up, with the collar basted in place (picture 1).
- Place the facing on top, right sides together, sandwiching the collar. Match the shoulder seams, the center front and the long edges of the Back Neck Facings with the back opening edges. Pin.
- Stitch in one go: from the hemline mark on one back opening edge, up to the neckline, around the neck, and down the other opening edge to the hemline mark (picture 2). The hemline is 2 cm above the lower edge of the Back.
- Trim the neckline seam allowance to 5 mm, clip into the curve every 1 cm, and trim the corners at the top of the opening.
- Understitch: press the seam allowances toward the facing and stitch on the facing 2 mm from the seam, as far around the neckline as you can.
- Turn the facing to the inside and press. The collar now lies flat on the dress (picture 3). Tack the facing to the shoulder seam allowances by hand.

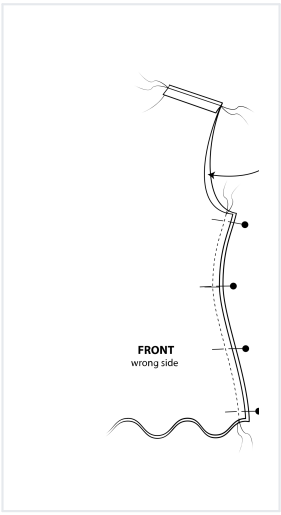
Video help: Understitching a facing



7 Side seams

Front + Backs

- Open the facing out of the way. Pin the Front to the Backs at the sides, right sides together, matching the notches.
- Stitch from the armhole down to the hem. Press the seam allowances open.

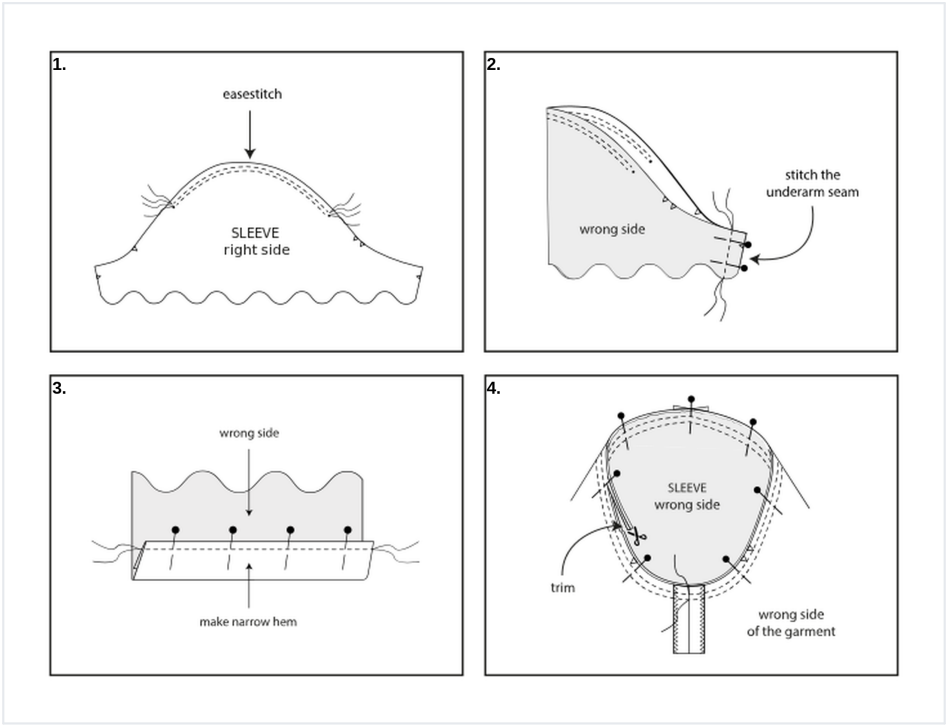


8 Set in the sleeves

Sleeves · pictures 1–4

- Easestitch the sleeve cap between the two dots: two rows of long stitches at 1.3 cm and 6 mm from the edge, leaving long thread tails (picture 1).
- Fold the sleeve right sides together and stitch the underarm seam. Press open (picture 2).
- Hem the sleeve: turn 5 mm, then 1.5 cm, to the wrong side, press and stitch close to the fold (picture 3).
- Turn the dress wrong side out and the sleeve right side out. Slip the sleeve into the armhole, right sides together. Match the top notch with the shoulder seam, the underarm seams together and all the notches.
- Pull the thread tails to ease the cap, spread the fullness evenly with no tucks, pin and stitch with the sleeve on top (picture 4).
- Stitch a second row 6 mm away inside the seam allowance, trim and finish together. Press toward the dress.

Video help: Setting in a sleeve

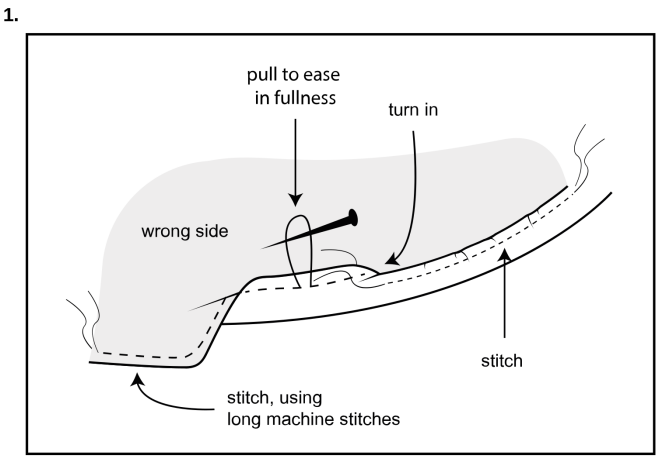


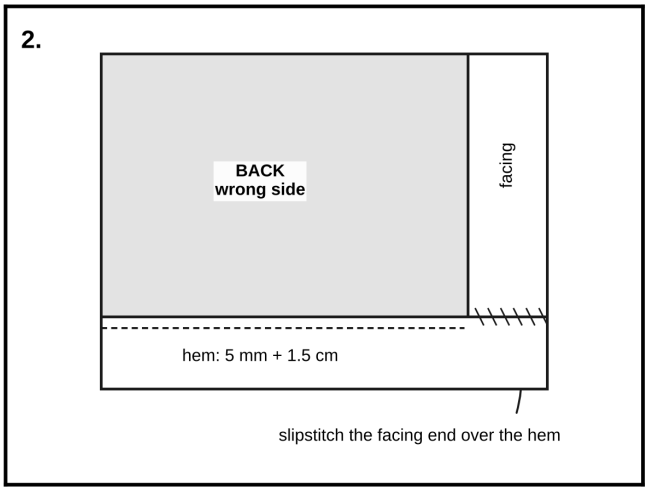
9 Hem

Dress · pictures 1–2

- Fold the facing out. Stitch 6 mm from the lower edge with a long stitch to help ease the curve.
- Turn up the 2 cm hem: first 5 mm, then 1.5 cm along the hemline, pulling the basting thread slightly where the hem is wider than the dress. Press (picture 1).
- At the back opening, the hem goes up to the opening fold. Bring the facing back to the inside, fold its lower end under in line with the hem and press.
- Stitch the hem close to the upper fold, from one facing to the other. Slipstitch the lower end of each facing over the hem by hand (picture 2).

Video help: Hemming a curved edge



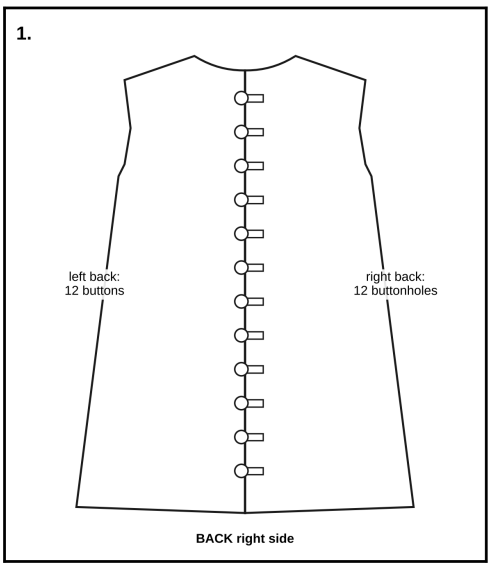


10 Buttonholes and buttons

Backs · 12 buttons

- Close the back: the right back (as worn) laps over the left back, center back on center back.
- Make 12 horizontal buttonholes, 1.2 cm long, on the right back at the markings. Each one starts 3 mm past the center back toward the opening edge.
- Cut the buttonholes open with a seam ripper, a pin across the end to stop it.
- Lap the backs, mark through each buttonhole and sew the 12 buttons on the center back of the left back.
- Give the whole dress a final press, the collar from the under side.

Video help: Perfect buttonholes



FINISHED!

Enjoy Your Dress



Styling ideas

- A white contrast collar on a gingham or small floral print for a classic look.
- In fine corduroy with tights and a cardigan for the colder months.
- Pretty mother-of-pearl or fabric-covered buttons to make the back special.

Care

- Wash at 30 °C inside out, with similar colours.
- Press the collar from the under side with a little steam.

Need help?

If a step is unclear, email us at contact@sewcraftlypatterns.com – we are happy to help.
Need it in another language? Email us your order number, we send it within 48 h.

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